Members Import Guide

Excel File Preparation & Upload Instructions for Members Table

Version 1.0

1. Overview

This guide explains how to prepare a Microsoft Excel file (.xls or .xlsx) for importing member records into the system. The import process reads the active sheet from your workbook, maps each column by its **exact header name**, validates the data, and inserts valid rows into the **members** table.

> **File Format:** Only `.xls` and `.xlsx` files are accepted. Ensure the file is not password-protected or corrupted before uploading.

2. Column Mapping Reference

The table below shows every expected Excel column header (first row), its mapped database field, whether it is required, and any special formatting rules applied during import.

Excel Column Header	Database Field	Required	Formatting Rules
Par#	ParticipantId	*Auto*	Auto-generated by the system. **Do not include** this column in your file, or leave it blank. Values from Excel are ignored.
Last Name REQ	LastName	**Yes**	Converted to UPPERCASE. Record is rejected if empty.
First Name REQ	FirstName	**Yes**	Converted to UPPERCASE. Record is rejected if empty.
Mi	MiddleName	No	Converted to UPPERCASE.
Address1	Address1	No	Converted to UPPERCASE.
Address2	Address2	No	Converted to UPPERCASE.
City	City	No	Converted to UPPERCASE.
State	State	No	Converted to UPPERCASE.
ZipCode	ZipCode	No	Left as-is (not uppercased).
Shift	Shift	No	Left as-is (not uppercased).
phone1	Phone1	No	All non-digit characters removed (keeps only 0-9). Not uppercased.
Status	Trans_flag	No	Converted to UPPERCASE.
Insurance Co	HMO_Enrolled	No	Converted to UPPERCASE.
Member ID	medicaid_HMO_id	No	Left as-is (not uppercased).
Auth No.	medicaid_PA_no	No	Converted to UPPERCASE.
Auth Start Dt	medicaid_PA_Start	No	**Date field.** Accepts Excel serial numbers or parseable date strings. Stored as `Y-m-d H:i:s`. Converted to UPPERCASE.

Excel Column Header	Database Field	Required	Formatting Rules
Auth End Dt	medicaid_PA_End	No	**Date field.** Accepts Excel serial numbers or parseable date strings. Stored as `Y-m-d H:i:s`. Converted to UPPERCASE.
Principal ICD Cd	PrimaryDiagnosis1	No	Converted to UPPERCASE.
Secondary ICD Cd	SecondaryDiag1	No	Converted to UPPERCASE.
DOB	DateOfBirth	No	**Date field.** Accepts Excel serial numbers or parseable date strings. Stored as `Y-m-d H:i:s`. Converted to UPPERCASE.
SS #	SSNo	No	All non-digit characters removed (keeps only 0-9). Not uppercased.
Sex	Sex	No	Converted to UPPERCASE.

Tip: The header names must match *exactly* as shown above, including spacing and punctuation (e.g., `Auth No.` includes a period; `SS #` includes a space and hash sign). Case sensitivity does not matter — headers are trimmed and compared as strings.

3. Excel File Structure

3.1 Basic Rules

- The first row **must** contain column headers matching the names in the table above.
- Data rows begin at row 2.
- Only the **active sheet** is read. Ensure the data is on the first/active sheet.
- **Empty rows** (all cells blank) are automatically skipped.
- There is no limit on the number of rows, but very large files may take longer to process.

3.2 Required Columns

- **Last Name** — record is rejected if empty.
- **First Name** — record is rejected if empty.

All other columns are optional. If a cell is empty, the corresponding database field will be set to `NULL`.

3.3 Participant ID (Par#)

The **ParticipantId** is **auto-generated** by the system. It increments sequentially starting from the highest existing `ParticipantId` in the database (or from **1001** if no records exist). You may include the `Par#` column in your file, but its values will be **ignored**.

> **Important:** If a `ParticipantId` already exists in the database, that row will be **skipped** during the final import confirmation step. The preview step checks for duplicates and flags them.

4. Data Formatting Rules

4.1 Text Fields (Uppercased)

Most text fields are automatically converted to **UPPERCASE**. Enter data in any case — the system will normalize it. The following fields are **not** uppercased:

- **ZipCode**
- **Shift**
- **Phone1**
- **medicaid_HMO_id** (Member ID)
- **SSNo** (SS #)

4.2 Phone Numbers & Social Security Numbers

For **phone1** and **SS #** columns, all **non-digit characters** are automatically stripped. Only digits `0-9` are kept. You may enter values with formatting:

- Phone: `(555) 123-4567` → stored as `5551234567`
- SSN: `123-45-6789` → stored as `123456789`

4.3 Date Fields

Three columns are treated as date fields: **DOB**, **Auth Start Dt**, and **Auth End Dt**. The system accepts two formats:

- **Excel serial date number** (e.g., `45000`) — the numeric value Excel uses internally for dates.
- **Parseable date string** (e.g., `2025-01-15`, `01/15/2025`) — any format PHP's `strtotime` or Carbon can parse.

All dates are stored internally as `YYYY-MM-DD HH:MM:SS`.

> **Recommendation:** To avoid ambiguity, format date columns in Excel as actual **Date** cells (not text). This ensures Excel serial numbers are used, which the system can reliably convert.

5. Step-by-Step Workflow

Step	Action	Description
1	Prepare Excel File	Create an `.xls` or `.xlsx` file with headers in row 1 and data from row 2 onward. Follow the column mapping above.
2	Upload File	Use the **Import Members** page to select and upload your Excel file.
3	Review Preview	After upload, the system displays a **preview** of parsed rows. Each row shows its status: • READY — valid row, ready for import. • ERROR — validation failed (see error message).
4	Confirm Import	Review the previewed data. Click **Confirm Import** to insert all rows marked **READY** into the members table. Rows with errors are excluded.
5	Cancellation	If the data is not satisfactory, click **Cancel** to discard the preview without importing anything.

6. Validation Rules

During the preview step, each row is validated against the following rules:

Rule	Error Message	Action
Last Name is empty	`Last Name is missing`	Row marked as **ERROR**; not imported.
First Name is empty	`First Name is missing`	Row marked as **ERROR**; not imported.
Generated ParticipantId already exists	`Generated ParticipantId already exists`	Row marked as **ERROR**; not imported. (This is rare since IDs are auto-generated.)

> **Important:** Rows with errors are **not** inserted into the database even if you click Confirm Import. Only rows with **READY** status are imported.

7. Sample Excel Template

Below is a minimal example showing the header row and two data rows:

Last Name	First Name	Mi	Address1	City	State	ZipCode	phone1	DOB	Sex
Smith	John	A	123 Main St	New York	NY	10001	(212) 555-0147	01/15/1985	M
Doe	Jane	M	456 Oak Ave	Los Angeles	CA	90001	3235550198	06/22/1990	F

> **Tip:** You do **not** need to include every column. Only include the columns for which you have data. Missing columns are treated as empty (NULL).